



BenQ PhotoVue SW242Q

Great value for photographers

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For creators, a reliable monitor is essential but often comes with a hefty price tag. To meet the genuine needs of creative work, a monitor needs to be capable enough to be trusted with colour and luminance accuracy. It must have an ergonomic design for marathon sessions and should offer seamless connectivity with other devices, accessories and peripherals that creators often use. The BenQ PhotoVue SW242Q enters this challenging landscape for an attractive price. But does it truly stand up to the demands of modern creators? Let's answer that question and more in our BenQ PhotoVue SW242Q experience!

Do not that apart from the monitor, we also had the BenQ ScreenBar Halo monitor light with us and we will also talk about whether it justifies its premium price of ₹15,990.

Design

The BenQ SW242Q has a subtle and professional look, featuring a large, flat leatherette base that enhances its appeal while offering a grippy surface to keep accessories like earbuds or your phone securely in place. The grey plastic arm is solid and provides sturdy support for the IPS LCD panel. The stand offers a great range of ergonomic adjustments, including height, tilt, swivel, and pivot. The adjustment specs are what you'd usually expect: 120mm of height adjustment, 30 degrees of swivel, and up to 20 degrees of tilt. A cable management loop is included to keep the rear tidy. However, we did encounter some difficulty clipping the cover tray back on after connecting our cables.

Bezels around the display are around 7mm thick on three sides with a thicker strip on the bottom edge. OSD menu can be controlled via joystick controls and

buttons (there is no wireless puck as in higher-end PhotoVue monitors). We like that the monitor has a dedicated info button which will be helpful for those who do colour-critical work and need to double-check the monitor settings every now and then during calibration. The Monitor Function Key is mapped to Colour Mode by default and can be used to quickly change the colour mode. You can also assign it to contrast, gamma, Input, and other frequently used functions.

This is a 16:10 monitor which means it's noticeably taller than regular 24-inch monitors. This extra height is especially beneficial for content creators and professionals who need more vertical screen space. I also found this particularly helpful while reading content and scrutinising mail trails.

Connectivity

Frequently used ports, including the card reader, audio jack, and USB 3.1 ports, are easily accessible on the bottom-left bezel, opposite the OSD menu buttons on the right.

On the rear, you get an HDMI port, a DisplayPort and a USB Type-C port. The USB Type-C port with 90W power delivery is particularly convenient and can be used to charge your laptop and smartphone. It also supports DisplayPort Alt mode for video input. There are no built-in speakers, but I personally have never really needed them on my monitors.

Display Quality

BenQ SW242 has a matte-finish IPS LCD display and comes with several assurance certifications. The monitor is Pantone Validated, Calman verified, and Calman ready. Professionals can perform hardware calibration according to their requirements using Calman software or Palette Master Ultimate. You can easily access popular colour presets including Adobe RGB, sRGB, Display P3, Rec.709 and HDR from the OSD menu. BenQ has made the Paper Colour Sync available on this affordable PhotoVue monitor. This mode can give you a more accurate preview of how your images will look when printed.